

# Taylor Simpson

[taylor.daniel.simpson@gmail.com](mailto:taylor.daniel.simpson@gmail.com)

Portfolio: [taylorsimpson.ca](http://taylorsimpson.ca) • [linkedin.com/in/td-simpson](https://linkedin.com/in/td-simpson) • Toronto, ON

## SUMMARY

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Product Designer with 6+ years spanning the full product lifecycle, from research and strategy to design, launch, and iteration. With a background in software development, product management, and UX writing, I bring a technical and strategic perspective that ties design decisions to user needs, business goals, and measurable growth.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Product Designer (Contract)

Feb. 2026 – Present

SettleKit

Remote

A personalized guidance platform that helps new immigrants navigate life in the USA using an adaptive content system tailored to each user's visa, goals, and progress.

- Conducted user research including interviews with new immigrants, translating qualitative insights into well-scoped UX specs covering flows, wireframes, and copy that bridged user needs and engineering delivery.
- Defined the information architecture, establishing how user actions and completed steps cascade across the product to unlock, sequence, and personalize guidance at every stage of the journey.
- Led UX writing across all surfaces, applying a context-first framework that established purpose before action, written in plain accessible language suited to non-native English speakers.
- Reframed the product's content model from rigid checklists to flexible guides, cutting content production time from weeks to days without requiring any backend changes.
- Designed the commercial provider experience, allowing users to set preferences and compare options within SettleKit's own interface, reducing drop-off at key third-party handoff points.
- Grew the platform from a limited MVP to a product with hundreds of active users, expanded topic coverage, and partnerships with banks and financial providers.

### Product Designer

Aug. 2024 – Feb. 2026

Social Good Fund

Remote

A 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsor. I worked on one of their initiatives – an iOS/Android app connecting people and organizations seeking help with those offering their time, skills, or donations.

- Delivered comprehensive UX specs – including user flows, wireframes, and copy that address core use cases, edge cases, and usability pain points, cutting concept-to-launch time by 40%
- Collaborated with engineers by implementing minor UX and copy fixes directly in the codebase, freeing them for higher-priority development and reducing overall implementation time by 20%
- Conducted regression testing, logging bugs / UX issues, reducing downtime and user-reported errors by 60%
- Owned in-app copy and contributed to marketing content; developed team-wide guidelines that standardized voice and tone, improving consistency and content production speed across the team
- Built and maintained the marketing website in WordPress, helping improve traffic and ad performance through SEO and A/B testing

### Product Manager

Sept. 2020 – Aug. 2023

Lexir

Remote

A B2B distribution and e-commerce SaaS platform enabling craft wine and spirit brands to enter the European market through importation, warehousing, e-commerce integrations, last-mile delivery, and local sales partner connections.

- Led the development and release of Lexir's brand dashboard and e-commerce platform
- Built the go-to-market strategy, product roadmap, and developed key brand messaging
- Conducted user research, A/B tested, and translated requirements for a design and dev team of 5
- Led regular client interviews to surface feature gaps and usage patterns, driving improvements to dashboards, data visualizations, and subscription models that improved retention and platform adoption

- Created and managed marketing campaigns across email, social media, ads, blogs, events, SEO, influencer marketing, and community outreach
- Grew the client base by 8x and scaled the platform from 1 market to 6 markets in Europe
- Reduced implementation costs by 60% by streamlining development methods

#### **Content Strategist**

Apr. 2018 – Mar. 2019

QHacks

Kingston, Ontario

- Developed and implemented marketing strategies for the biggest university event post-orientation week, attracting 1200+ applicants and \$100k+ in sponsorships
- Led all external communications, writing and editing copy across the website, dashboard, handbooks, emails, and ads, and created the brand's first content style guide used by a team of 20 (and still used today)

#### **Software Developer**

May 2018 – Dec. 2018

Orange Gate Consulting

Toronto, Ontario

- Spearheaded a new department developing Android-based applications for consumer robots, leading Orange Gate to shift its core business focus toward robot applications
- Designed wireframes, user flows, and prototypes presented in person to C-Suite client executives in the financial services and automotive industries at client sites in Toronto and Detroit

### **EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT**

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#### **Queen's University**

2015 – 2019

Bachelor of Computing, Computer Science, Specialization in Software Design

Kingston, ON

- Teaching Assistant: Artificial Intelligence (CISC 352)
- Marketing Commissioner: Computing Students' Association

#### **Smith School of Business at Queen's University**

2016 – 2020

Certificate in Business

Kingston, ON

#### **BrainStation Toronto**

2023 – 2024

UX Design Certificate

Toronto, ON

### **SKILLS**

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- **Design & Research:** Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe XD, UX Design, Prototyping, Wireframing, User Research, UX Writing
- **Product & Strategy:** Agile Development, Product Roadmapping, Go-to-Market Strategy, Data Analysis, Digital Marketing, Marketing Analytics
- **Technical:** Python, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React.js, Node.js, Java, SQL, Git, Jira, Linear, Confluence, Microsoft Suite
- **AI Tools:** Claude, Claude Code, Cursor

### **ADDITIONAL INFO**

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- **Awards:**
  - o People's Choice in Human-Computer Interaction – Queen's Creative Computing Showcase (2018)
  - o Top 4 Hack – Hack the 6ix (2017)
- **Fun Achievements:**
  - o Game Show Winner – Splatalot
  - o Silver Medalist – Canada East Short Track Speed Skating Championship
  - o Guinness World Record – Largest Rubik's Cube Mosaic